TAP IN, SPOKEN CADDIE

AI Caddie & Scorekeeper

A complete summary of what the app does, and how to use every part of it on the course and at home.

User Guide

September 2026

1. What the app is

AI Caddie & Scorekeeper is a phone-based golf caddie. It lives in the browser (best in Chrome on Android) and can be saved to the Home Screen like an app. It watches GPS, looks up wind and elevation, picks a club, talks you through a sensible plan for the hole, and keeps score when you tap. It talks back. It does not listen.

It is built for a real round: big buttons, Bluetooth earbuds, and a caddie that talks. You tap. It speaks. It knows the difference between being at home and being on a golf course, so it will not nag you to mark a pin in the kitchen.

What it does well

- **Finds you.** GPS decides whether you are off-course or on a mapped golf course.
- **Loads the scorecard.** GolfCourseAPI supplies the course name, par, and yardage. Mark the pin once; the phone aims there next round.
- **Gives a plays-like number.** Raw GPS yards are adjusted for elevation, wind, and your recent distance misses.
- **Recommends a club** from your bag, then a strategy for that shot.
- **Manages the hole like a caddie.** Handicap, par, and scorecard length change the advice: club down on short par 4s, lay up on long par 5s, extra club when the number is awkward, miss to the fat of the green.
- **Talks like a caddie.** Irish male voice when the phone has one, otherwise a male voice with Irish phrasing. It uses your name (default Kerry).
- **Keeps score** hole by hole, including undo, skip, and finish round. Rounds survive a refresh and finished cards sit in Round History.
- **Learns your miss.** Tap Came up short, Flew long, Missed left, or Missed right and it nudges yardages and aim.

What it is not

It is not a laser rangefinder, a full course CAD package, or a Tour caddie with every bunker book. Yardage aims at the pin you mark on the green. GolfCourseAPI does not include bunkers, water, or green coordinates. Club distances start as a generic bag until you train them. Use it as a smart yardage and strategy partner, then trust your eyes on anything it cannot see.

2. First-time setup

Do this once at home, with a few minutes and a decent signal. It pays off on the first tee.

Install it on the phone

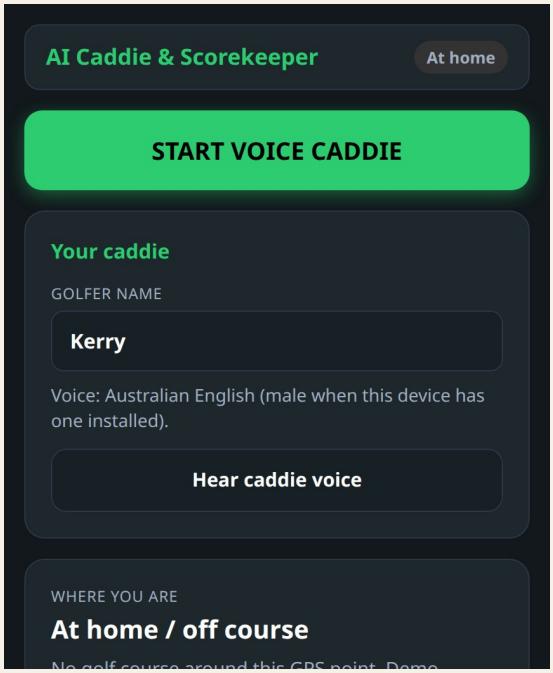
- Open the app in **Chrome on Android** or Safari on iPhone. Both can speak. Neither needs the microphone.
- Allow **Location** when asked. High-accuracy GPS is how yardage and course detection work.
- Turn the phone volume up, or use earbuds, so you can hear the caddie.
- Add to Home Screen (Chrome menu → Add to Home screen / Install app) so it opens full screen like a native app.
- After an update, force-close and reopen, or pull to refresh, so you are not stuck on an old cached copy.

Irish male voice

The caddie asks the phone for a male voice and prefers Irish English. The lines are written the way an Irish caddie would say them: club, the playing yardage, and where to aim. If the phone has no Irish male voice, it still uses a man — a UK male voice is the next choice — and it will not pick a woman's voice while any male voice is

installed.

- **Android or a Windows browser:** Settings → Text-to-speech. Install **English (Ireland)** and pick **Connor** if he is listed. Skip Emily.
- **iPhone:** There is no male Irish system voice. Settings → Accessibility → Spoken Content → Voices → English (UK). Download **Daniel** (male). Do not use Moira — she is Irish, and she is a woman.
- Back in the app, tap **Hear caddie voice**. You should hear “How's it going, Kerry…” (or your name), from a male voice.



Your caddie card: name, handicap, play style, and a voice preview.

Tell it who you are

- **Golfer name** defaults to Kerry. Change the field. When you leave it, the caddie says the new name.
- **Handicap** defaults to 14. Set your real number. This is not vanity — it changes strategy.
- Handicap 0–8: more aggressive when the shot is on. 9–18: play smart (club down, lay up, fat of the green). 19+: protect the double.
- Changing the handicap field makes the caddie say the new play style.
- **Bag** is its own screen, opened from the Bag button. Add, remove, or change carry yards there. The caddie only recommends clubs from that list. Remove takes a club out of play but keeps its yards; add the same name back (or tap Add back) to restore it. Reset bag restores Driver through Lob Wedge. Round brings you back to yardage and score.

> **Why handicap matters.** A 14-handicap on a 273-yard par 4 should hear “5-wood, leave a wedge,” not “hit driver at the flag.” A 5-handicap can take more risk. Put in the number you actually play to.

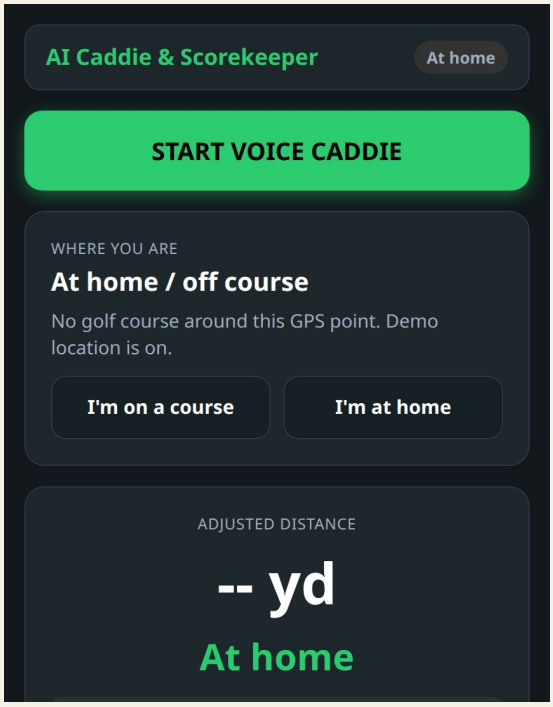
3. Home versus the course

After GPS settles, the Where you are card is the truth. Read it before you start hunting for a pin.

At home / off course

If GolfCourseAPI has no course within 2 miles, the app stays in scorekeeper mode. The big number stays blank, Laser GPS says Off course, and the pin button is **Drop practice pin** — optional, for backyard testing only. You

can still add strokes, preview the voice, and review history. It will not demand a pin.



Off-course view. Scorekeeping works; pin setup stays out of the way.

On a course

Paste a GolfCourseAPI key under Your caddie, then tap Find. You do not have to leave the box first. It stays on the phone. A Pro key finds the nearest course within 2 miles. A free key can search by course name with **Find**. The card shows the course, the tee, and a hole strip with par and scorecard yardage. Walk to your ball after the pin is marked; the plays-like number and club update. Tap a hole number if you are on a different hole. If several tees are listed, pick the one you are playing.

When the course is missing

If the search finds nothing, tap **I’m on a course**. Then stand on the green and tap **Mark Pin Here**. Walk back to the ball for yardage. Repeat on each green. If the app thinks you are on a course when you are in the driveway, tap **I’m at home**.

Teaching a green

GolfCourseAPI publishes the scorecard, not the green. Dashed hole numbers still need a pin. On the tee, tap **Save tee here**. On the green, **Mark Pin Here**. The phone keeps those points. Next round the caddie aims at the saved pin. This stays on the device; it is not uploaded.

4. How to play a round

This is the full loop. Do it in this order and the rest of the app falls into place.

1. First tee. Open the app, confirm the course name, check hole 1 and par. Allow GPS to settle for a few seconds while you stand still.

2. Start the caddie. Tap **Start Caddie**. You should hear a greeting with your name, and the screen stays awake. The microphone is not used.

3. Tee shot. If you are on the tee of a mapped hole, you will already have a number and a plan (for example club down on a short par 4). Tap **Ask Caddie** and listen.

4. Hit, then log. After the swing, tap **Add Stroke**. Do this for every swing including penalties you want on the card. **Undo Stroke** if you double-tapped. **Good shot** counts the stroke and remembers a solid strike.

5. Walk to the ball. Stand still over the ball. The GPS and plays-like figures update. Ask again. The plan changes from tee-shot advice to approach or lay-up advice.

6. Green and pin. Mapped greens are the centre. If the pin is tucked or the map is off, walk to the flag and **Mark Pin Here**. Then walk back.

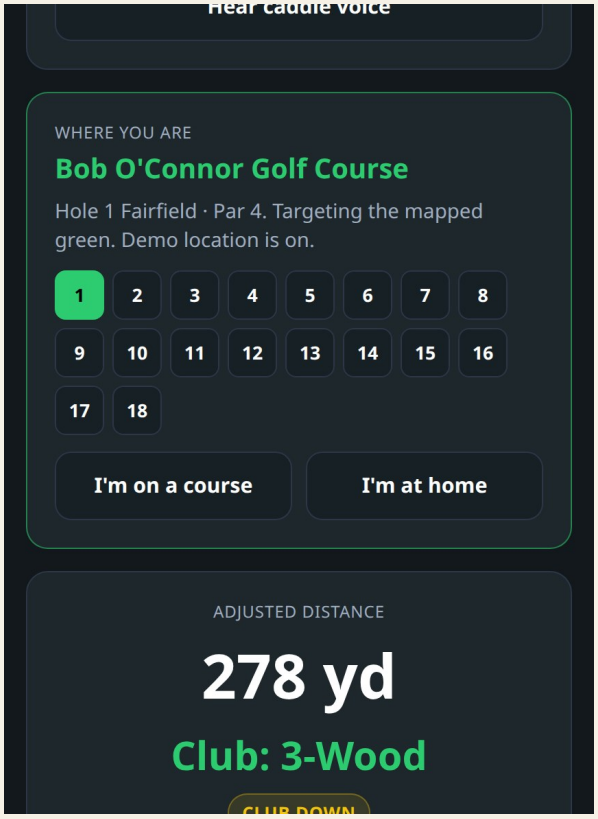
7. Finish the hole. When the ball is in, tap **Next Hole**. It stores par and strokes, then aims at the next green, and says the score. Use **Skip Hole** only if you did not play it.

8. Finish the round. Tap **Finish Round**. The current hole is included if it has strokes. A card is written to Round History and the scorecard resets.

> **Golden rule.** Count the stroke after you hit, then walk, then ask. If you ask from the tee after you have already played, the advice will still sound like a tee shot. Keep the scorecard honest and the strategy stays honest.

5. Reading the numbers

- **Adjusted distance (plays-like)** is the number to club. It is GPS yards plus elevation, wind along your line, and a small personal distance bias.
- **Laser GPS** is the raw map distance to the current target (green or marked pin).
- **Elevation impact** — uphill plays longer, downhill shorter.
- **Wind velocity** is speed and direction. Headwind/tailwind is already folded into plays-like.
- **Club** is the bag club whose stock distance best matches the *intended shot*, not always the remaining yards to the flag (a 400-yard par 5 does not mean “hit driver at the green”).
- **Play plan** is the strategy label: Play smart, Club down, Lay up, Attack when it’s on, Protect the double.
- **Shot shape bias** moves from Neutral toward Fade/Slice or Draw/Hook as you log left and right misses.



On a short par 4 at handicap 14: 5-wood, club down, leave a full wedge.

6. Course strategy, used properly

The caddie is trying to save doubles, not paint flags. It uses your handicap, the hole's par, whether you are on the tee, remaining yards, and the scorecard length of the hole.

How it thinks

- **Short par 4s (typical 14-handicap):** 5-wood or 7-wood off the tee, wedge in. Driver can run through.
- **Par 3s:** fat of the green is a good 3. Extra club if trouble is short.
- **Par 5s:** fairway first. If the green is not on in two for your bag, it lays up to about a full wedge (~110 yards) instead of recommending driver at a 280-yard green.
- **Approaches:** extra club for mid- and high-handicaps (amateurs miss short). Aim the middle. If a bunker or water sits short, take more club and miss long or centre.
- **Low handicaps (0–8):** more licence to attack when the number is in scoring range, still missing on the fat side.
- **Your miss:** a stored fade starts you left of the safe line; a draw starts you right.

GolfCourseAPI does not send bunkers or water, so the spoken plan will not name a hazard. You still get par, scorecard length, and handicap advice. If you can see trouble, play the trouble you can see.

7. Scorekeeping

Every hole needs a par and a stroke count. Default par is 4 until you set it. On mapped holes, par comes from the course data when you land on that hole.

- Set par with the **Par 3 / 4 / 5** buttons, or leave the par that arrived with a mapped hole. The selected par is highlighted.
- **Add Stroke** after every shot you want on the card.

- **Next Hole** refuses to advance if there are zero strokes (use Skip Hole if you walked it).
- **Finish Round** saves a history card with date, holes played, and score to par. In-progress rounds survive closing the tab.
- Relative score (E, +3, –1) includes the current hole only after you have started it.

8. Training your bag

The stock bag is Kerry’s: driver 220, 5-wood 210, 7-wood 200, 3-hybrid 190, then irons and wedges. Remove a club if you are not carrying it; the yards stay on the phone so adding it back restores the number. The miss buttons still tune those numbers after real shots.

- After a shot with the recommended club, tap **Came up short** or **Flew long**. That club’s number moves two yards and a small distance bias is stored. Tap **Ask Caddie** first so it knows which club.
- **Missed left** and **Missed right** build a fade or draw bias used in aim advice.
- **Good shot** logs a hit and adds a stroke.
- Be honest and consistent. A handful of real misses is more useful than tapping at random on the couch.

9. Tap reference

You do not talk to the app. Tap the button, then listen. The caddie uses an Irish male voice when the phone has one, and Irish phrasing in a male voice otherwise. Tap **Stop Caddie** in the car if you want the screen to sleep and the current sentence to stop. The buttons still speak if you tap them.

Tap this	What you hear
Ask Caddie	Playing yardage, the club, and where to aim.
Mark pin / Override pin	Saves GPS as the target. On a missing green, this is remembered for next round.
Save tee here	Saves this tee for the current hole on this phone.
Hole number on the strip	Jumps to that hole and its green.
Where am I?	Home versus course name and hole.
I’m at home / I’m on a course	Overrides GPS if the map is wrong.
Golfer name field	Sets the name used when the caddie speaks.
Handicap field	Sets handicap and play style, then says it.
Par 3 / 4 / 5	Sets the current hole’s par and highlights that button.
Add Stroke	Adds one stroke and says the count.
Undo Stroke	Removes the last stroke on this hole.
Next Hole	Stores the hole and advances.
Skip Hole	Advances without storing strokes.
My score	Hole, strokes, and score to par.
Finish Round	Writes Round History and resets.
Good shot	Hit logged and a stroke added.

Tap this	What you hear
Came up short / Flew long	Tunes that club’s yardage.
Missed left / Missed right	Updates fade/draw bias.

10. How to get everything out of it

- Stand still for two seconds before you ask. GPS jumps while you walk.
- Ask from the ball, not from the bag cart twenty metres away.
- Set the real handicap before the round, not after the 7th hole.
- On mapped courses, glance at the hole strip. If you are on 12 and it still says 1, tap 12.
- Override the pin when the flag is tucked or the green map is clearly the wrong blob.
- Log every stroke, including the duffed chip. Strategy assumes the count is true.
- Use earbuds so you can hear the plan without staring at the screen in sunlight.
- After we ship an update, reopen the installed app so the new service worker loads.
- Practice pin at home is only for testing GPS. Leave it unused unless you are debugging.

11. If something looks wrong

If you see this	Try this
Still asking to mark a pin at home	Force-refresh or reopen the Home Screen app so you are not on an old version. Confirm Location is on. Tap I’m at home if you live next to a course.
Woman's voice, or a US accent	Install English (Ireland) and choose Connor. On iPhone download Daniel (UK male), not Moira. Tap Hear caddie voice again.
Voice says Assamese or another language	Reopen the app so this version loads. The caddie only uses an English voice. Install English (UK) Daniel, or English (Ireland) Connor.
No course name on the first tee	Paste a GolfCourseAPI key and tap Find. You do not have to leave the key box first. Pro keys find a course within 2 miles. If the name is missing, tap I’m on a course and mark the pin.
Yardage is hundreds of yards off	Wrong hole is selected, or an old pin is still stored. Tap the correct hole, or mark pin from the green you are actually playing.
The caddie stays silent	Turn the volume up. Tap Hear caddie voice again. Each tap wakes the phone's speech engine. Install an English voice in Spoken Content.
I expected it to hear me	It does not use the microphone. Tap the button for what you want, then listen.
Wind or elevation shows dashes	No signal to Open-Meteo. Raw GPS yards still work; club from Laser GPS until data returns.

12. Data, cost, and honesty

The caddie itself has no subscription. Location, voice, score, and saved pins live on the phone. Course names and scorecards come from GolfCourseAPI, using the key you paste in. That key stays on the phone and is sent only to api.golfcourseapi.com. Wind and elevation come from Open-Meteo. GPS course search is a GolfCourseAPI Pro feature. Name search works on their free key.

The scorecard does not include green coordinates. Teach each green on the round: Save tee, then Mark pin. Those points stay on the phone for next time. The caddie will still keep score either way.

On the first tee, in one line. Confirm the course and hole, set handicap, tap Start Caddie, tap Ask Caddie, hit, tap Add Stroke, walk, ask again, tap Next Hole. Do that eighteen times. That is the whole app.